Diego J. Mora Benitez

Economist · Data & Fiscal Policy Analyst

Buenos Aires, Argentina | +54 11 2250-4637 | morabdiego@gmail.com | Github

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Economist (University of Buenos Aires) specialized in **applied econometrics (SARIMAX, difference-in-differences, cointegration), tax analytics and socioeconomic research**. I currently advise the Executive Directorate of ARBA, the Buenos Aires Province tax agency, on subnational revenue forecasting and data-driven tax enforcement; previously I led nationwide household surveys in low-income neighborhoods. I work across the full data cycle —collection, reproducible pipelines, modeling and decision-support dashboards— using **Python, Polars, SQL and Git**.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ARBA — Buenos Aires Province Tax Agency — Oct. 2025 – Present

Economist Advisor | La Plata · Executive Directorate and Tax Analysis Dept. (Fiscal Intelligence Division)

- Designed and implemented in Python **econometric and predictive models (SARIMAX and cointegration)** to forecast **Gross Income Tax (IIBB)** revenue across all jurisdictions using COMARB data, achieving **MAPE below 5% in every case**.
- **Automated model specification:** the system tests specifications (log-log, ratios, year-over-year changes, transitory and level dummies) and refines them over 24 successive iterations until the MAPE criterion is met.
- Developed **fiscal intelligence algorithms** and large-scale database cross-matching over hundreds of thousands of taxpayers for automated audits and targeted enforcement in the agricultural sectors, identifying **ARS 500 million in unpaid tax**.
- Built standardized **ETL pipelines** that improved processing speed and reproducibility across millions of tax records.
- Designed the quantitative and incentive framework of the **ARBA-Puntos** tax compliance program and assessed its revenue impact and effect on taxpayer behavior using **difference-in-differences**.

A.C. La Poderosa — Socioeconomic Observatory — Jan. 2020 – Present

Socioeconomic Research Coordinator & Data Lead | Buenos Aires

- **Led nationwide research projects** in partnership with UNICEF, ACIJ, IIGG-UBA, Rosa Luxemburg Foundation, Friedrich Ebert Foundation and SAGE Foundation: methodological design (sampling, conceptual frameworks, instruments) and fieldwork at national scale. Main studies:
  - *Household debt in low-income neighborhoods (2026):* quota sampling in 7 provinces on informal credit circuits and non-monetary costs.
  - *Time use and community work (2025):* 1,096 households in 71 neighborhoods across 14 provinces; adapted the INDEC national time-use survey (ENUT) classifier to measure the triple workday. Provided the empirical basis for the *Community Cooks' Wage Bill* submitted to the Argentine Congress.
  - *Others: Living conditions (2022, 2024):* 1,485 households and 5,024 people in up to 6 provinces (housing deficit, electrical hazards, urban infrastructure). *Menstrual health management (2021):* 2,478 households and 3,598 people in 67 neighborhoods across 22 provinces. *Child poverty and community networks (2022):* nationwide qualitative study with UNICEF Argentina.
- **Data infrastructure and automation:** designed data capture and quality control with XLSForm/KoboToolbox and built Python libraries on the Kobo REST API for ingestion, consistency validation and cleaning (ETL). Developed Telegram bots that monitor fieldwork progress in real time and apply consistency rules to submissions.
- **Open science:** created and maintain **Observadata**, the Observatory's open data repository, with anonymized microdata, structured metadata and publication on GitHub/Zenodo with DOIs and open licenses.

- **Outreach:** coordinated the content and architecture of the Observatory's official website, designed accessible data visualizations, and serve as its technical spokesperson in media, press conferences and academic forums.

RENABAP — National Registry of Low-Income Neighborhoods May – Dec. 2023
Regional Coordinator | Ministry of Social Development

- Coordinated fieldwork logistics and execution: schedules, coverage targets and crew supervision, reporting progress to Ministry authorities.
- Recruited, trained and supervised 30+ field surveyors, maintaining cross-checks of data consistency in the field.

La Ley de la Selva — C5N (TV) May – Sep. 2024
Economics and Data Columnist | Buenos Aires

- Turned complex datasets (inflation, economic activity, income, labor market) into live TV segments with static and dynamic charts, maintaining statistical rigor in coordination with the production team.

EDUCATION

University of Buenos Aires — Bachelor's Degree (Licenciatura) in Economics Sept. 2023

IPAP – UTN La Plata — Diploma in Data Analysis for the Public Sector In progress · Dec. 2026

Additional training

- Tableau, Statistics, GIS, administrative records for statistical production, and R programming — IPAP (2026)
- Data storytelling: analysis, interpretation and visualization of data — Fundar (2025)
- Python Programming for Data Science — Argentina Humana (2024)
- R Programming — Ecofeminita (2023)

SKILLS

Languages and tools: Python (Polars, pandas, NumPy, SciPy, statsmodels, scikit-learn, PyArrow), R (Tidyverse), SQL, Git/GitHub, Linux/Bash.

Econometrics and methods: SARIMAX, time series, difference-in-differences, cointegration, automated model selection, subnational revenue forecasting, large-scale cross-matching for fiscal intelligence, multidimensional indices, mixed methods.

Data engineering: ETL pipelines, REST APIs (KoboToolbox), Telegram Bot API bots for real-time validation and monitoring.

Data collection and fieldwork: XLSForm (KoboToolbox, ODK, SurveyCTO), probability and quota sampling, time-use surveys, data quality auditing.

Visualization: Streamlit, Tableau, Flourish, Matplotlib, Seaborn.

Open science: microdata anonymization, FAIR-standard metadata, GitHub and Zenodo repositories (DOI).

Languages: Spanish (native); professional working English (technical reading, documentation and economic literature).